ICT&L REVENUE

Revenue
Cáin agus Custaim na hÉireann
Irish Tax and Customs

VAT3 Webservice

VAT3 Return Rules

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Audience

This document is for any user/software provider who wish to understand the validation errors associated with Revenue's VAT3 Webservice.

Document Context

This document provides details of the validation error messages for the VAT3 Webservice.

Related Documents

This document should be read in conjunction with the following documents:

Document Name	Description
Rest Webservice Integration Guide	Document which provides a technical overview of how to integrate with Revenue's REST web services including how to sign requests validly.
VAT3 Schema Notes	Describes the schema structure for the VAT3 request, covering the expected elements, data types, and an example XML file.
VAT3 Webservice Error Structure	This document provides details of REST error message structure for the VAT3 Webservice.
Sample HTTP messages	Example files of http response messages.

1. Introduction

This document provides a reference guide for the validation errors that can arise when submitting a VAT3 return via the webservice. The system performs a series of automated checks to ensure that submitted data is accurate, complete, and compliant with both technical specifications and underlying tax rules.

Each entry in the table below details a specific error scenario, linking the message returned by the API to the underlying error description.

The validations cover several categories, including:

- Request Format & Structure: Ensuring the submitted payload is well-formed and adheres to the defined schema.
- Data Integrity: Checking for mandatory fields, correct data types, and valid character lengths.
- Business Rule Compliance: Verifying filing periods, currency, user permissions, and consistency between related data fields.
- Duplicate Prevention: Ensuring the same original return is not submitted multiple times.

2. VAT3 Return Rules

Error Description	Message Returned
Currency Mismatch: The currency in the uploaded file does not match the currency of the user's registration.	**Error:** The currency selected does not match the currency associated with this registration
Duplicate Upload: A file for the same registration and period has already been submitted.	**Error:** This original VAT3 Return has been previously uploaded
Invalid Client: An agent is attempting to upload a file for an ID that doesn't match their selected client.	**Error:** User does not have VAT3 filing permissions (Unlinked Agent/Invalid Client)
Language Missing: The XML file is missing the required language attribute.	**Error:** Language is empty or is not E (English) or G (Irish)
XML Format Error: The file structure is incorrect, missing required attributes, or not following ROS standards.	**Error:** Invalid or malformed XML format
Period Not Outstanding: User is filing for a period that isn't open or is missing an original return for a supplementary return.	**Error:** The tax period does not match an outstanding tax period for this registration. **OR** **Error:** An original return must be filed for this period.

Incomplete Unusual Expenditure: The value 'Y' has been provided for the "Unusual Expenditure" field, but amount and details are missing.	**Error:** Unusual Expenditure Amount and Details fields are required when Unusual Expenditure is selected
File Frequency Period Selection Issues	**Error:** Incorrect start or end date for selected filing frequency period
A "Service to/from" EU field (e.g., ES1, ES2) contains a negative number or has been left blank.	**Error:** Services To/From EU fields not populated
Postponed Accounting Inconsistency: A value was entered for Postponed Accounting (PA1), but the corresponding VAT was not included in the T1 (VAT on Sales) or T2 (VAT on Purchases) totals.	**Error:** As a value has been entered in PA1 then this figure must also be accounted for in both T1 and T2. Please enter a value greater than zero for {0} field
Missing Data: A mandatory field or sub-component is left blank.	**Error:** Missing required fields in your VAT3 Return
VAT Registration Number Format Error: The Registration Number entered does not match the required VAT Registration Number pattern .	**Error:** Invalid format of VAT Registration Number
Maximum Limit Exceeded	**Error:** Maximum Limit Exceeded - The numeric value entered is higher than the maximum value allowed
Minimum Limit Not Met	**Error:** Minimum Limit Not Met - The numeric value entered is lower than the system allows
Maximum Character Limit Exceeded	**Error:** Maximum Character Limit Exceeded - The text entered exceeds the allowed character count
Minimum Character Limit Not Met	**Error:** Minimum Character Limit Exceeded - The text entered is shorter than the required character count